

KEPLER

Space telescope

Launched in March 2009, the Kepler Space Telescope has discovered a record number of planets orbiting other stars. It has spent years studying a small region in the constellations Cygnus and Lyra, checking for stars that dim periodically as planets move in front of them. By mid-2016, Kepler had discovered 2,325 planets.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 4.7 m (15.4 ft) long



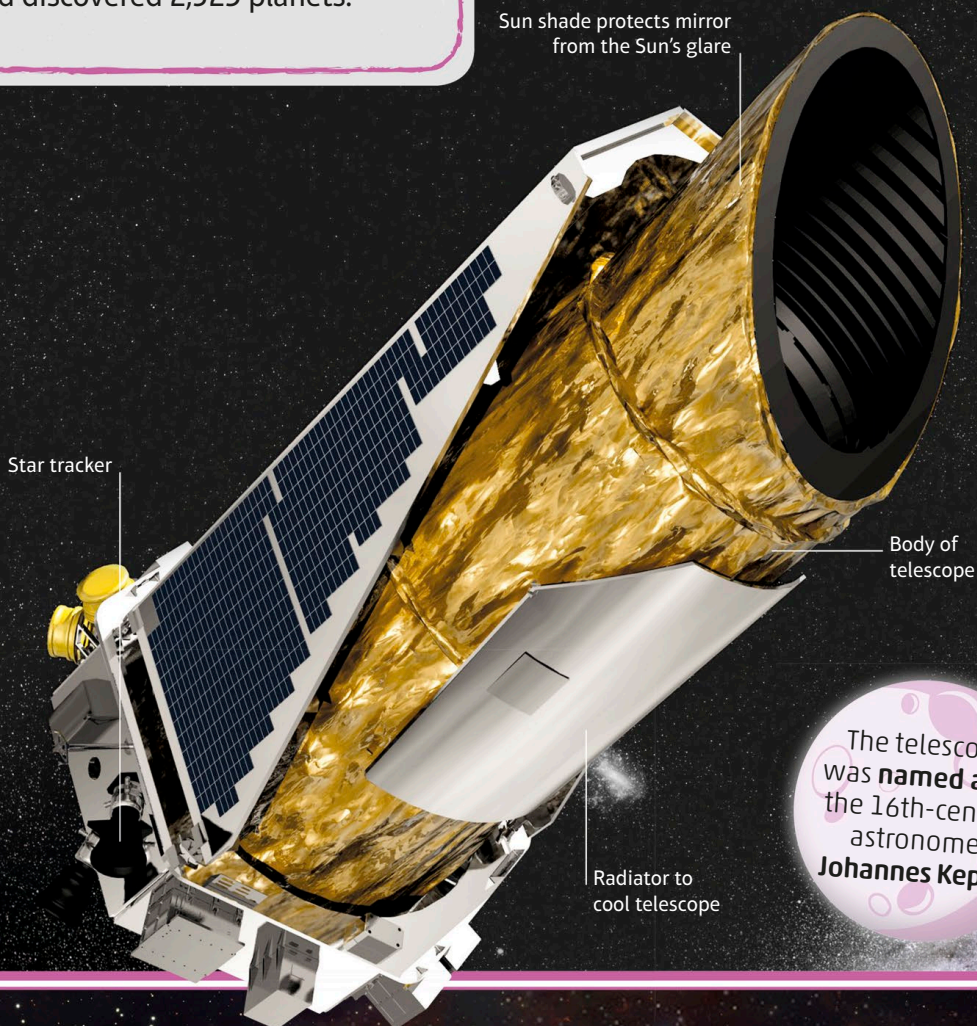
DATE OF LAUNCH: 7 March 2009



MISSION DURATION: Ongoing



SPACE AGENCY: NASA



The telescope was **named after** the 16th-century astronomer, **Johannes Kepler**.